

Adult Guide — E01 *Something Is Here*

Review edition 2.0.0 Author: Maria Smith Audience: parents, carers, early-years practitioners and teachers Final-publication status: awaiting Maria Smith's approval

What this book does

This is a complete picture-book adventure for children aged three to five. It does not require the companion game. Mia arrives at the Tower of Star Rooms and meets Sol and Tavi. A note asks the new team to “find nothing”. Five clues lead them through an empty box, a quiet bell, a blank card, a hidden teddy and two shelves. Nori joins the team for this book’s listening clue.

The child experiences each idea before it is named. The story never treats “nothing” as a secret object. It helps the child say exactly what happened: the teddy is not in the box; the bell did not ring during one short listen; the card has no mark; the curtain blocks the teddy from view; and one shelf has no card on it.

The ending explains the lesson directly. Clear words help us describe what we really saw, heard or checked instead of inventing an answer.

How to share it

Read slowly and let the pictures carry part of the story. A child may point, trace, speak, sign, copy an action, watch, or opt out. The activities are made for paper. No page asks a child to tap a digital button, drag an on-screen object or unlock a game state.

Use three simple prompts when useful:

1. “What can you see?”
2. “What changed?”
3. “How could we check?”

Accept a different first answer and look again together. The next page is a shared check, not a score screen. Do not rush to supply a learning word before the child has had time to notice the event.

The story in order

Pages 3–8 — welcome and the note

Mia enters the tower, meets Tavi and Sol, and reaches the shut Star Door. A note comes through the slot and lands on the floor. The child first finds the note among three clear emoji objects, then Mia reads it. This establishes the problem and shows exactly where the note came from.

Pages 9–12 — the box and teddy

The first star points to a box. The teddy is visibly inside before it is moved out. The child traces the teddy's route. Only then does Mia explain "empty": the teddy is not inside the box now, while both box and teddy still exist.

Pages 13–16 — Nori and the bell

The team walks into the listening room and meets Nori. The bell rings once, then stops. The child listens or watches for one comfortable breath. "Quiet" describes that short check. The bell, room and listening friends remain.

Pages 17–20 — the blank card and written word

The quiet bell remains behind as the next star leads to the paper room. A card is shown before "blank" is explained. The child may make a mark on separate paper or leave it clear. The letters N-O-T-H-I-N-G are then read from left to right. The visible word is a record the team can see and say; it is not a secret object called nothing.

Pages 21–24 — the curtain

The teddy rolls behind a closed curtain. The child follows its prints and predicts where it is. The next page opens the curtain and shows the same teddy. "Hidden" means blocked from this view, not gone.

Pages 25–28 — the two shelves

All five stars open the way. The team compares two matching shelves. One shelf holds a card; the other has no card on it. The result is stated carefully: one card was presented, and no card was presented on the other shelf. The team does not invent an unseen object to fill the empty place.

Pages 29–32 — remember, explain and continue

The child matches four familiar emoji clues to the words EMPTY, QUIET, BLANK and HIDDEN. The narrator then joins the discoveries into one clear lesson and explains why precise words matter. Nori says goodbye. The map is safely filed before a parcel travels down the established delivery slide, giving the next book a natural beginning without leaving this story unfinished.

Paper activities and answers

Find the note — page 7

The child points to the NOTE emoji, not the MAP or BOOK. Ask for the object's name before turning the page.

Trace the teddy — page 11

Trace from the teddy inside the box to the rug. The physical relation changes: the teddy moves from inside the box to outside it.

One comfortable listen — page 16

A grown-up claps once. The clap stops, and the bell does not ring again. Do not demand silence or stillness from the child. A spoken or signed "quiet now" is enough.

Mark or leave clear — page 18

Use separate paper and a thick crayon if desired. A marked card has a mark; a blank card has no mark. In both cases the card is present.

Read NOTHING — page 20

Point from left to right and say the letters. Treat this as playful print awareness, not a spelling test.

Find the hidden teddy — page 23

Follow the visible prints to the closed curtain. The reveal on page 24 confirms the prediction without pretending that a hidden object disappeared.

Match the clues — page 29

BOX matches EMPTY. BELL matches QUIET. BLANK CARD matches BLANK. TEDDY matches HIDDEN. Let the child trace each gold path and say, sign or indicate the word.

Repeated-object rule

Every repeated learning object uses the same recognisable emoji throughout the series. This prevents a child from having to decode a newly generated version of the same object on each page.

- note emoji
- box or parcel emoji
- teddy emoji
- bell emoji
- blank card emoji
- pencil emoji
- door emoji
- star emoji
- lantern emoji

Generated illustrations are used for the world, characters, feelings and story action. They are not the authority for the identity of repeated learning objects. Emoji artwork is OpenMoji 16.0, licensed CC BY-SA 4.0.

Useful words

- **empty** — the named thing is not inside the container now;
- **quiet** — the named sound did not happen during this short check;
- **blank** — there is no mark on this card;
- **hidden** — something blocks it from this view;

- **word** — letters placed together so they can be read;
- **remember** — bring an earlier event back to mind; and
- **check** — look, listen or try again within the activity.

Avoid “nothing was there” when a more exact sentence is available. Say “no card was on this shelf” or “the bell did not ring during our listen”. These sentences tell the child what was checked and what result was found.

Accessibility and safety

The book is usable by looking, pointing, listening, speaking, signing or watching an adult model the action. The accessible HTML edition gives each page a semantic heading and a complete picture description. Colour is never the only carrier of an answer; object identity is reinforced by shape, position, emoji and words.

Optional props may include a large open box, a familiar soft toy, a bell controlled by an adult, sturdy paper, a thick crayon and a cloth. Avoid small parts, blindfolds, enforced silence and hiding an essential comfort object.

Exact SFT source and boundary

Claim: SFT-R00T-THERE-IS-NO-NOTHING Status: independently replicated Provenance: direct forcing Closure: depth-independent within the declared operational boundary Receipt: sha256: 711864171e4d3a2f2734f0c2890965bcd81a0228349538751a3c80699c27d669

Exact statement:

No admissible operational statement, denial, record, proof object or derivational object is nothing: absence presents no counterexample, while every presented counterexample is an occurrence.

The declared grammar has two classes. Unpresented absence supplies no statement, denial, record, trace or identity, so it supplies no operational counterexample. Presented occurrence supplies a statement, denial, record, trace or identity; that presentation is an occurrence and is not nothing.

The theorem does not claim knowledge of an unexpressed metaphysical domain. The child scenes are educational translations and do not create a new proof. External curricula, image tools, voice tools and emoji art are references or production tools only. They are not authorities in Smithian Fold Theory derivation.

Review status

This is a live open educational review edition. It may be corrected and versioned when language, layout or accessibility becomes outdated. Edition 2.0.0 remains outside publications/education until Maria Smith explicitly approves this exact student book and adult guide.